

and maintaining a habit.

- 37. One need not abandon their goals completely just because they missed their target temporarily; they can start anew.
- 38. Research shows it is quite another challenge to maintain a behavioral change after you have initiated it.
- 39. It is wrong to assume the strategies we use to start a change of behavior will work equally well in helping maintain it.
- 40. Sometimes, it may not be successful to simply substitute one activity with another to effect a change of habit; you may need extra reinforcement.
- 41. One should introduce something new to replace an old habit instead of simply kicking it.
- 42. Perfectionists focus too much on their big target and neglect celebrating the small gains they make in the process.

编者注：“长阅读”题型Directions规定：You may choose a paragraph more than once, 即同一个段落可能不止针对一道题，故会出现本套题第39题和第45题同选K段的情况，请读者知悉。

43. It is of great benefit to us in the long term to conquer the inertia that stops us from making behavioral changes.
44. The strategy that successfully changed one of your behaviors may not work for some other behavior of yours.
45. Without a happy mood, it seems that our wisdom to adopt a different behavior vanishes.

Section C

Directions: *There are 2 passages in this section. Each passage is followed by some questions or unfinished statements. For each of them there are four choices marked A), B), C) and D). You should decide on the best choice and mark the corresponding letter on **Answer Sheet 2** with a single line through the centre.*

Passage One

Questions 46 to 50 are based on the following passage.

The “American Dream” promises that in the Land of Opportunity, any individual can climb the economic ladder and prosper through hard work and ambition alone. And yet, young Americans today are struggling to earn more than their parents did at the same age, and upward mobility in the US actually compares unfavourably to that of other industrialised nations.

So why does the idea of the American Dream persist? A new study in the *American Journal of Political Science* identifies one factor that has been overlooked: the influence of reality TV.

Reality shows have come to dominate US television over the past 20 years, notes Eunji Kim from Vanderbilt University. And the overwhelming majority of these have a “rags-to-riches” storyline: they feature ordinary Americans who work hard to achieve great economic success. And while these programmes are regularly among the most-watched shows, news broadcasts—which paint a more realistic view of the economic hardship faced by millions of Americans—get a much smaller proportion of the viewership.

Rags-to-riches stories are *ubiquitous* (无处不在的) on TV—but does watching these programmes actually convince people that economic mobility is easily attainable? To find out, Kim’s team had participants watch a 5-minute clip from a reality show with a rags-to-riches storyline. Control participants watched a clip from a reality show that didn’t have a rags-to-riches story. After watching the shows, participants rated how much they agreed with four statements relating to the American Dream.

The results showed that those who’d watched a rags-to-riches clip did indeed have a significantly greater belief in the American Dream. Interestingly, when participants were separated by party affiliation, this effect was significant among Republicans but not Democrats, suggesting that the kind of messages implicit in these TV shows may play into people’s existing socioeconomic beliefs.

Kim also conducted a survey of 3,000 US residents. They also rated the extent to which they believed success in life is related to various internal factors (such as ambition) and external factors (such as family wealth). Finally, they read a list of TV programmes and indicated which they regularly watched.

Participants who were heavy viewers of rags-to-riches programmes or frequent viewers had a stronger belief in the American Dream than those who never watched such shows.

Kim concludes that “rags-to-riches entertainment media are an important cultural force that promotes and perpetuates beliefs in upward mobility”. And here’s the problem: if people mistakenly believe that hard work is all that is needed for individuals to make a better life for themselves, they may be less supportive of policies that could actually combat inequality.

“In this era of choice, entertainment media are what captures hearts and minds,” Kim writes. “Its political consequences are anything but trivial”.

46. What do we learn from the passage about young Americans of today?
- A) They have greater ambitions than their parents.
 - B) They find it difficult to achieve upward mobility.
 - C) They have overtaken their parents in terms of earnings.
 - D) They envy the opportunities in other industrialised nations.
47. What does Kim's team find about reality TV shows in America?
- A) They reinterpret the essence of the popular rags-to-riches culture.
 - B) They urge people to achieve economic success through hard work.
 - C) They help strengthen people's conviction in the American Dream.
 - D) They feature ordinary Americans striving for social recognition.
48. What does the author say about news broadcasts in America?
- A) They attract far fewer viewers than reality TV.
 - B) They are bent on reporting the dark side of life.
 - C) They stand in striking contrast with reality TV.
 - D) They focus on Americans' economic hardships.
49. What can we infer from the passage about Republicans in general?
- A) They believe strongly in the American Dream.
 - B) They strive to climb the socio-economic ladder.
 - C) They have a very strong affiliation with their party.
 - D) They tend to watch more rags-to-riches TV shows.
50. What is stated about people who believe in upward mobility?
- A) They are likely to blame the government for their plight.
 - B) They regard political consequences as anything but trivial.
 - C) They respect individuals striving to climb the social ladder.
 - D) They are less likely to approve of policies to fight inequality.

Passage Two

Questions 51 to 55 are based on the following passage.

When someone asks us 'what do you do?' we nearly always reply with our occupation. Work, for many of us, is much more than a job. It is the defining aspect of our identity. For many of us it is through our job that we can define ourselves.

"Without my job I don't know who I am," is a sentence that has been uttered on more than a handful of occasions from my office chair. Indeed, it can be one of the most challenging aspects I work on with clients who have lost or been forced into changing their jobs. This loss provokes an identity crisis much greater than the loss of the job itself.

One of the things I have come to understand, however, is that our identity is much more complex than we recognise at first glance. If we take the time to reflect we might recognise that as well as our work we can also identify as a friend, a spouse, a son or daughter, a parent, a member of a sports team or religious community. We may recognise that we feel and act differently in these roles and relationships than we do at work. The passive daughter becomes an assertive leader at work. Furthermore, our identities at work are not static. They change over time. I myself have been a shop assistant, a waitress, a student, a graduate, and a clinical psychologist. At each stage my ability to adapt to and develop my career identity has been crucial to my wellbeing. Whilst we like to eliminate uncertainty in our lives at some level we have to manage uncertainty, especially in today's volatile and ever-shifting job market.

How we see ourselves is central to the issue of our identity. When we tell ourselves “I’m good at starting projects but not so great at seeing them through” it can become part of our belief system. But if you have the unfortunate experience of an enforced job change you will need to examine those beliefs to see how grounded in reality they are. You will be required to ask yourself how helpful these beliefs are and consider personal change. We can change our beliefs, behaviours and emotional experience at any time through experimentation, practice and conscious self-discipline. In an age where career progression may lead us into new sectors it is ever more important to challenge our sense of self and explore whether you can create a new experience of your identity by changing the beliefs you hold about yourself in order to expand your career options. Ultimately it is you who define who you are. You are only your job if you let it be so.

51. What do we learn from the passage about one’s loss of a job?

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| A) It compels them to visit a clinical psychologist. | C) It renders them puzzled about who they are. |
| B) It offers them a chance to play different roles. | D) It forces them to redefine their life’s goals. |